# ■ THE DAILY GOODS STORY SCOUT - Monday, September 21, 2026

## TODAY'S RUNDOWN SLOTS

## THE LIST (5 stories)

### ■■ *US solar can now generate enough clean electricity to power more than 50 million homes, over one third of all households. The country added 11.4 GW of solar in Q2 2026, up 45% from a year earlier, while solar and battery storage made up 70% of all new power capacity in the first half.*

***The Angle:*** *Clean energy just hit a real tipping point, not just a feel-good stat, and it's a story every listener can connect to their own power bill and the bigger fight over how America keeps the lights on.*

- US solar can now generate enough electricity to power **more than 50 million homes** - over **one third** of all US households.
- The country added **11.4 GW** of solar in **Q2 2026**, up **45%** from a year earlier.
- Solar and battery storage together made up **70%** of all new power capacity added in the first half of 2026.

**The Debate Starter**

- Solar's growing faster than almost anyone predicted - does that change how you feel about going solar at your own house, or are you still skeptical on cost and reliability?

Reddit r/upliftingnews (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://freepress.org/article/solar-news-week-september-13-2026

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### ■ *People hate Flock so much its employees are now demoralized and thinking of quitting*

***The Angle:*** *Flock Safety's surveillance cameras and license-plate readers have become a national flashpoint over privacy and policing, and now the blowback is reportedly hitting morale inside the company itself - a real 'when the controversy comes home' story.*

- **Flock Safety** employees are reportedly demoralized amid mounting public backlash against the company
- Some staffers are said to be considering quitting because of how intense the criticism has gotten
- The claim is circulating via a widely discussed thread on **Reddit's r/technology**

**The Debate Starter**

- If the public hates what your company builds, is quitting the responsible move or just passing the buck?

Reddit r/technology (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://www.neowin.net/news/people-hate-flock-so-much-that-its-employees-are-now-demoralized-and-thinking-of-quitting/

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### ■ *Microsoft patents system to freeze games and inject ads during downtimes — watching commercials earns ad-free playtime credits*

***The Angle:*** *Microsoft just patented a system that pauses gameplay to force ads on you mid-session — and gamers are already furious about paying full price for a game that might interrupt itself to sell you something.*

- **Microsoft** filed a patent for a system that freezes gameplay during **"downtimes"** to slot in ads.
- Watch the ad, and you bank **ad-free playtime credits** to redeem later — basically buying peace and quiet.
- It's a patent filing, not a confirmed feature — nothing's shipped yet, but the backlash is already loud online.

**The Debate Starter**

- You already paid for the game — should Microsoft still get to pause it and sell you a car insurance ad?

Reddit r/technology (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://www.tomshardware.com/video-games/microsoft-patents-system-to-freeze-games-and-inject-ads-during-downtimes-watching-commercials-earns-ad-free-playtime-credits

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### ■ *Hideo Kojima Says Sony Canceled Physint Over A Zoom Call And Claims He Still Doesn't Know The Reason Why*

***The Angle:*** *Legendary game designer Hideo Kojima is going public with how brutal the end of his Sony partnership really was - and the mystery is what's hooking people: even he says he doesn't know why it happened.*

- **Hideo Kojima** says **Sony** canceled his project **"Physint"**
- He claims the cancellation news came via a **Zoom call**
- Kojima says he **still doesn't know the reason** why it was scrapped

**The Debate Starter**

- A Zoom call to kill a multi-year passion project - is that just modern business, or ice cold for a legend like Kojima?

Reddit r/technology (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://kotaku.com/hideo-kojima-says-sony-canceled-physint-over-a-zoom-call-and-he-still-doesnt-know-the-reason-why-2000735931

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### ■ *Microsoft patent describes in-game advertising triggered by boss fights, loading screens, and cutscenes*

***The Angle:*** *Microsoft's floated a patent for shoving ads into loading screens, cutscenes, and mid-boss-fight moments in games - exactly the kind of "we already paid for this" outrage that gets gamers and non-gamers alike fired up about where advertising doesn't belong.*

- The patent reportedly comes from **Microsoft**, spotted circulating on **r/technology**
- It describes triggering ads during specific in-game moments: **boss fights**, **loading screens**, and **cutscenes**
- It's a patent filing, not a confirmed feature - but patents like this usually signal where a company's thinking is headed

**The Debate Starter**

- You already paid $70 for the game - where's the one moment an ad pop-up would make you throw the controller?

**ON-AIR BIT BREAKDOWN**

- **Step 1: Set It Up** - 30 seconds -> Hosts explain the patent: Microsoft eyeing ads that hit during boss fights, loading screens, cutscenes.
- **Step 2: Phone Line Callout** - 2-3 minutes -> Ask listeners to call/text the single worst in-game moment an ad could interrupt - funniest or most infuriating answer wins bragging rights.
- **Step 3: Host Ranking** - 1 minute -> Hosts rank the top 3 listener answers live and argue over which is truly the most unforgivable.

Reddit r/technology (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://www.techspot.com/news/113909-microsoft-patent-describes-game-advertising-triggered-boss-fights.html

Backup options:

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### 🛩■ *The largest all-electric plane ever flew for 27 minutes, on $5 of electricity*

***The Angle:*** *This is one of those 'wait, what?' tech stories that makes people picture the future of travel — a full-size electric plane taking off for pocket change in energy costs, at a moment when everyone's talking about gas prices and climate.*

- It's being called the **largest all-electric plane** ever flown.
- The flight lasted **27 minutes** in the air.
- Total electricity cost for the flight: just **$5**.

**The Debate Starter**

- Would you actually board an electric passenger plane, or does that feel like a bridge too far?

Reddit r/futurology (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://www.techspot.com/news/113540-heart-aerospace-30-seat-electric-plane-takes-flight.html

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### ■ *Engineered Probiotic Wipes Out 43% of Colorectal Tumors in Mice: The engineered E Coli packed a triple-whammy – chemotherapy produced directly inside the tumor, an immune stimulant, and a localized form of immune checkpoint blockade.*

***The Angle:*** *It sounds like sci-fi, but researchers engineered a probiotic bacteria to hunt down colon tumors and hit them with a three-pronged attack - and it wiped out nearly half the tumors in mice. Early-stage, but it's the kind of wild science headline that gets people talking about the future of cancer treatment.*

- Engineered **E. coli** wiped out **43% of colorectal tumors** in mice
- The bacteria delivers a **triple-whammy**: chemo made directly inside the tumor, an immune stimulant, and localized immune checkpoint blockade
- The chemotherapy is produced **right at the tumor site** - not pumped through the whole body like traditional chemo
- Still in the **mouse trial stage**, but seen as a major proof-of-concept for 'living drug' cancer therapies

**The Watercooler Science Moment**

- Would you sign up to have engineered bacteria fight your cancer from the inside out?

Reddit r/futurology (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://www.sciencealert.com/engineered-probiotic-wipes-out-43-of-colorectal-tumors-in-mice

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### ■ *What AI Anxiety Looks Like in China*

***The Angle:*** *AI anxiety isn't just a Silicon Valley story anymore — China's government-driven AI rollout is creating a totally different kind of public panic, and it's a preview of what happens when a tech revolution gets forced from the top down instead of growing organically.*

**The Debate Starter**

- Would you rather AI disruption hit you fast and top-down, or slow and messy like it's happening here?

Reddit r/futurology (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://www.theatlantic.com/international/2026/09/beijing-ai-popularity-regulation/688597/

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## CANADIAN NEWS (3 stories)

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### ■ *Carney ranked best public speaker, most quotable, hardest working, and one of the best fundraisers in The Hill Times' 30th annual Politically Savvy Survey*

***The Angle:*** *A survey of political insiders just crowned the PM the best speaker, most quotable, and hardest worker in Ottawa — the kind of glowing report card that begs the question of whether it matches how Canadians actually feel about him.*

- **Mark Carney** was ranked the **best public speaker** in **The Hill Times'** survey
- He also topped the list for **most quotable**
- Insiders rated him the **hardest working** politician in Ottawa
- He placed among the **best fundraisers**, per the **30th annual Politically Savvy Survey**

**The Debate Starter**

- Does Ottawa's opinion of Carney match how you feel about him, or are the insiders living in a different world?

Reddit r/canada (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://www.hilltimes.com/2026/09/21/prime-minister-mark-carney-pulls-ahead-in-best-public-speaking-and-most-quotable-categories-in-the-hill-times-30th-annual-politically-savvy-survey/518266/

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### ■ *Poilievre says Canada will never be ’28th state’ of EU at Ontario rally - National*

***The Angle:*** *A federal leader drawing a hard line on Canadian sovereignty at a live rally is easy tape for hosts to react to, especially with trade and identity debates already simmering north of the border.*

- **Pierre Poilievre** made the comment at a rally in **Ontario**
- He said Canada will never be the **"28th state"** of the **EU**
- The line is framed as a sovereignty statement amid ongoing trade talk

**The Debate Starter**

- Is this a real concern for Canadians or just a applause line - what's actually driving the sovereignty talk right now?

Reddit r/canada (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://globalnews.ca/news/12066501/poilievre-eu-canada-alliance/

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### ■ *Millions of driver’s licences were allegedly listed for sale on the dark web. What does it mean for Canada’s coming social media age ban?*

***The Angle:*** *Reports say millions of Canadian driver's licences turned up for sale on the dark web — and it's landing right as Ottawa pushes a social media age ban that would require ID verification to get online, so the timing couldn't be worse.*

- Reports allege **millions of Canadian driver's licences** were listed for sale on the **dark web**
- The news breaks just as Canada moves forward with a **social media age ban**
- That ban would likely require users to verify their age with **government ID**
- Critics are already asking: if this data isn't safe now, why hand over more of it?

**The Debate Starter**

- Would you trust a government age-verification system with your ID after hearing this?

Reddit r/canada (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://www.hilltimes.com/2026/09/16/millions-of-drivers-licences-were-allegedly-listed-for-sale-on-the-dark-web-what-does-it-mean-for-canadas-coming-social-media-age-ban/518247/

Backup options:

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### ■ *The Corporate Takeover of Canada’s Apartments Is Worse than You Think*

***The Angle:*** *This Reddit thread digs into corporate landlords scooping up rental buildings across Canada — a housing affordability nerve that's already raw for anyone renting right now.*

**The Debate Starter**

- Ever found out your landlord is actually a faceless investment firm? Call in and tell us.

Reddit r/canada (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://thewalrus.ca/the-corporate-takeover-of-canadas-apartments-is-worse-than-you-think/

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### ■ *His Hyundai Santa Fe burst into flames on busy highway after repairs at dealership*

***The Angle:*** *A guy's Hyundai catches fire and blows up seconds after he escapes — and it happened right after a dealership repair, so this is a real 'wait, what did they even fix' story that taps into everyone's fear of car trouble and getting the runaround from a dealer afterward.*

- **Jason Pelletier** was driving to work in **June** when his **Hyundai Santa Fe** suddenly caught fire
- He got out just seconds before the **front end exploded**
- The fire happened on a **busy highway**
- **Three months later**, he says he's still waiting for answers — and pushing for more compensation

**The Debate Starter**

- You just got your car back from the shop — how long before you'd actually trust it again?

www.cbc.ca (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://www.cbc.ca/news/business/hyundai-vehicle-fire-compensation-9.7350140?cmp=rss

### ■ *Canada faces questions over treatment of Iranian conscripts as U.K, Australia take different approach*

***The Angle:*** *This is a real immigration flashpoint — people forced into Iran's military are landing in Canada, and critics say we're not handling their cases the way allies like the UK and Australia do.*

- **Canada** is facing criticism over its treatment of **Iranian conscripts** seeking refuge
- The **U.K.** and **Australia** are reportedly taking a different, more lenient approach to the same cases
- Story raises questions about whether forced conscripts should be treated differently than willing regime affiliates

**The Debate Starter**

- Should someone forced into military service by a regime they didn't choose be treated the same as a willing soldier?

www.cbc.ca (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://www.cbc.ca/news/canada/canada-faces-questions-over-treatment-of-iranian-conscripts-as-u-k-australia-take-different-approach-9.7346224?cmp=rss

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## ENTERTAINMENT (4 stories)

### ■ *AI ‘Actress’ Tilly Norwood Glitches and Abruptly Starts Speaking Cantonese During Piers Morgan Interview*

***The Angle:*** *Tilly Norwood, the AI-generated 'actress' that's already got Hollywood in an uproar, reportedly glitched mid-interview with Piers Morgan and switched languages out of nowhere — proof the whole AI-actor experiment might not be ready for live TV.*

- **Tilly Norwood** is the AI-generated "actress" that's been stirring controversy in Hollywood.
- She sat down for an interview with **Piers Morgan**.
- Mid-interview, she reportedly glitched and started speaking **Cantonese** out of nowhere.

**The Debate Starter**

- If an AI 'actress' can't even make it through one live interview without glitching, should Hollywood really be worried about her taking real actors' jobs?

Reddit r/entertainment (Tier 1) | Score: 82/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 25 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://people.com/ai-actress-tilly-norwood-glitches-changes-language-during-piers-morgan-interview-12129604

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### ■ *Peter Krause’s ‘Line of Fire’ Is a Promising and Engaging NBC Procedural Drama: TV Review*

***The Angle:*** *A new cop-show universe drops this week, and the twist is it's inspired by Jenna Bush Hager's real Secret Service days — that's a fun collision of 'Today Show mom' and gritty NBC drama.*

- Stars **Peter Krause** in NBC's new procedural **'Line of Fire'**
- Created by **Joshua Safran**, the mind behind **'Quantico'**
- Loosely based on executive producer **Jenna Bush Hager's** real experiences with the **U.S. Secret Service**
- **Variety's** review calls it 'promising and engaging'

**The Watercooler Angle**

- Jenna Bush Hager helped produce a Secret Service drama — did anyone else not know she had that in her background?

variety.com (Tier 2) | Score: 82/90 (45 fit + 8 source + 29 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://variety.com/2026/tv/reviews/line-of-fire-review-nbc-1236861470/

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### ■ *Ed Sheeran Faces Boycott Calls After Agency Boss Casey Wasserman's Name Appears 109 Times in Epstein Files*

***The Angle:*** *Fans are calling for a boycott after Ed Sheeran's powerhouse agent, Casey Wasserman, turned up 109 times in newly released Epstein documents - and now the internet wants to know what Sheeran knew, if anything.*

- **Casey Wasserman**, CEO of Wasserman Media Group and longtime agent to **Ed Sheeran**, reportedly appears **109 times** across the Epstein files.
- Online chatter - centered on **Reddit's r/fauxmoi** - is calling for fans to boycott Sheeran over the association with his agency's boss.
- No allegations have been made against **Ed Sheeran** himself - the backlash is entirely about his business ties to Wasserman.

**The Guilt-By-Association Debate**

- Is it fair to boycott an artist over who signs his paychecks, or does 'know your circle' actually matter in 2026?

Reddit r/fauxmoi (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://i.redd.it/a8v4w86pipqh1.png

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### ■ *Marc Lamont Hill to Ed Sheeran: Are you crying for Palestinian babies? I mean, what are you crying for?*

***The Angle:*** *A pointed public callout of a beloved pop star taps right into the celebrity-activism minefield — easy watercooler fuel on whether stars get to pick and choose which tragedies they cry about.*

- Commentator **Marc Lamont Hill** directly challenged **Ed Sheeran**, asking: **"Are you crying for Palestinian babies? I mean, what are you crying for?"**
- The exchange is circulating on **r/fauxmoi**, framed as a call-out of Sheeran's public display of emotion.
- Limited details available beyond the quote itself — no confirmed context yet on what prompted Sheeran's tears.

**The Debate Starter**

- Do celebrities owe us consistency in which tragedies they publicly cry over, or is that an unfair gotcha?

Reddit r/fauxmoi (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://v.redd.it/ul39oynm8pqh1

Backup options:

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### ■ *Pattie Gonia: "I'm not gay as in 'love wins'… I'm queer as in 'fuck Ed Sheeran.' He didn't learn anything and while he may not be a bad person he didn't prove himself to be a good one. I will be donating to the PCRF on behalf of everyone who attended our show and encourage every artist to …"*

***The Angle:*** *A viral celebrity callout always gets people talking, and this one's got a sharp quote, a public feud angle, and a charity twist — easy fodder for a hosts' debate on accountability vs. clout.*

- **Pattie Gonia** didn't mince words: **"I'm queer as in 'fuck Ed Sheeran.'"**
- Says **Ed Sheeran** "**didn't learn anything**" and, while maybe not a bad person, "**didn't prove himself to be a good one**"
- Announced they'll be **donating to the PCRF** on behalf of everyone who attended their show
- Publicly encouraging other artists to do the same

**The Debate Starter**

- Is a public callout like this fair accountability, or just clout dressed up as a cause?

Reddit r/fauxmoi (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://v.redd.it/nfpq7zrmzqqh1

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### ■ *Luigi Mangione thanks fashion house in a letter*

***The Angle:*** *The accused killer everyone's been weirdly obsessing over just got outed as having impeccable taste, and the internet can't decide if that's hilarious or deeply unsettling — pure watercooler chaos.*

- A **March 2025 letter** from **Luigi Mangione** surfaced, addressed to **High Society**, a bespoke tailoring shop.
- He thanked the shop for **custom fits** the atelier gifted him.
- His quote: the clothes let him **'stunt on some haters.'**
- The shop is described as an **independent, bespoke** tailoring house.

**The Debate Starter**

- Is it wild that an accused murderer has fans thirsting over his tailoring — or has true crime fully merged with stan culture at this point?

Reddit r/fauxmoi (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://www.reddit.com/gallery/1wlpp5g

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### ■ *11 things we learned from the Neil Peart documentary*

***The Angle:*** *Rush fans (and drum nerds everywhere) have a new documentary to obsess over, digging into what made Neil Peart one of rock's most legendary and cerebral drummers.*

- The documentary is called **Neil Peart: No One's Disciple**
- It focuses on his **musicianship**, **intellectual curiosity**, and **resilience**
- Frames his **lasting influence on rock music** as a drummer and lyricist for **Rush**

**The Fan Debate**

- Is Neil Peart still the greatest rock drummer of all time, or does the new generation have a case against him?

www.cbc.ca (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://www.cbc.ca/news/entertainment/neil-peart-rush-documentary-9.7343638?cmp=rss

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### ■ *From ‘Andor’ to ‘Hit Man’ and (Maybe?) Wonder Woman: Charting Adria Arjona’s Path to Movie Stardom*

***The Angle:*** *She's gone from scene-stealer in 'Andor' and 'Hit Man' to real awards buzz - and now there's Wonder Woman chatter swirling, which is the kind of casting rumor that gets pop culture fans talking.*

- **Adria Arjona** is being profiled as a rising **movie star** with real staying power, not just a flash-in-the-pan
- Her breakout roles include **'Andor'** and **'Hit Man'**
- She's now in the conversation for a **Wonder Woman** casting - though nothing's confirmed

**The Casting Debate**

- Would you buy Adria Arjona as the next Wonder Woman, or does that role need a bigger name?

nypost.com (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://decider.com/2026/09/21/adria-arjona-movies-onslaught-hit-man-andor-more/

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## TRENDING TODAY

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### ■ *Russia retaliates against record drone blitz with Kyiv warehouse strike*

***The Angle:*** *This is the drone war escalating to a scale we haven't seen yet - over a thousand drones in one night is a record, and it shows neither side is backing off heading into fall.*

- **Ukraine** launched a record-breaking overnight barrage of **more than 1,000 drones** targeting **Moscow**
- **Russia** retaliated with a wave of drone strikes across the **Kyiv region**
- A direct hit on a warehouse complex in the **Boryspil district** sparked a **massive fire**
- At least **one person** was injured in the strike

**The Debate Starter**

- A thousand drones in a single night - is this the new normal for this war, or a sign it's about to get a lot worse?

nypost.com (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://nypost.com/video/russia-retaliates-against-record-drone-blitz-with-kyiv-warehouse-strike/

Backup options:

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### ■ *Ed Sheeran: Israel's treatment of Gazans 'unjustifiable,' apologizes for Macklemore controversy*

***The Angle:*** *One of the biggest pop stars on the planet just waded straight into the Israel-Gaza debate AND owned up to a public spat with Macklemore in the same breath - that's two watercooler moments in one headline.*

- **Ed Sheeran** called Israel's treatment of people in **Gaza** "unjustifiable"
- He also issued an **apology** tied to a controversy involving **Macklemore**
- Details on what sparked the Macklemore dust-up are still thin - worth digging into before air

**The Debate Starter**

- Should musicians be using their platform to weigh in on geopolitics, or should they just stick to the music?

CTV News (via Google News) (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://news.google.com/rss/articles/CBMi0gFBVV95cUxOckJmajhWN0w0LWpJOWhLLVBlRGRHT2pFTnJOaGRldEdJcnpfZTFLSXlta0huUHV1dHFPbzFfTDRNWFI3anhtUGVLMm80RFJwbjEyS2pTQVpuS2pGX0FSSkRBTDl1SWVnZWpIVXdLNmt2S0d1d1hHT3RkSWpNRzczb1U0T09MWFhWa0tZNHRYeXlZTElhTXNMWWlWN0pSVHdVbnRjWC1nUjU1Vk9YQVlqXzlZNWZHdUVkdE1MeW9QZ2tRS2U2dmpIZ0IzbE5SZHowaWc?oc=5

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### ■ *Budget airline king Bill Franke warms to first-class seats and premium upgrades - CNBC*

***The Angle:*** *Bill Franke basically invented the no-frills airline model with Spirit and Frontier, so him warming up to first-class seats and premium upgrades is a real signal the entire budget flying experience could be shifting.*

- **Bill Franke** co-founded **Indigo Partners** and chairs **Frontier Airlines**
- He's long been the architect behind stripped-down, bare-bones budget carriers
- Now he's reportedly warming to **first-class seats and premium upgrades** at those same airlines
- The shift comes as ultra-low-cost carriers have struggled to keep their old model profitable

**The Debate Starter**

- Would you actually pay more for a fancier seat on Frontier or Spirit, or is the whole appeal that it's cheap and no-frills?

CNBC (via NewsAPI) (Tier 1) | Score: 77/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 20 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://www.cnbc.com/2026/09/20/bill-franke-frontier-spirit-budget-airlines.html

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## LIFESTYLE CHAT

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### ■ *Researchers used Claude to hack OpenAI*

■ **Breakout potential** (editorial judgment, below the usual engagement bar): An AI-on-AI security story (Claude used to hack OpenAI) is a novel, self-referential hook that plays directly into the current AI-safety news cycle and is far more newsworthy than its 53 upvotes suggest.
***The Angle:*** *Two rival AI companies, one allegedly used to poke holes in the other — it's the kind of tech-world plot twist that sounds made up, which is exactly why it landed on r/nottheonion.*

**The Irony Alert**

- Nothing says 2026 like one AI chatbot allegedly being the tool used to hack another AI company.

Reddit r/nottheonion (Tier 1) | Score: 86/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 29 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://arstechnica.com/ai/2026/09/researchers-used-claude-to-hack-openai/

Backup options:

### ■ *It's funny that they are ok with this considering how much of an issue they have with men dating younger women https://t.co/di3nVa34s4*

***The Angle:*** *A viral tweet calls out what it says is a glaring double standard - people cheering something on that they'd drag men for doing when it comes to dating younger women. It's the kind of "wait, hold up" callout that instantly splits a room.*

**The Debate Starter**

- Ask listeners: is this actually a double standard, or is there a real difference nobody's naming?

X/Twitter @WomenBeingAwful (Tier 1) | Score: 80/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 23 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://x.com/WomenBeingAwful/status/2101851502323126421

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### ■ *Alzheimer's disease starting to be considered a treatable condition - study*

***The Angle:*** *For decades Alzheimer's has been framed as inevitable and untreatable - new research pushing back on that is genuinely hopeful news for the millions of families dealing with it, and a rare good-news health story worth pausing on.*

- New research suggests **Alzheimer's** may be shifting from an "incurable" label to a **treatable condition**
- Marks a notable change in tone from how the disease has traditionally been discussed medically

**The Personal Connection**

- Ask listeners: has Alzheimer's touched your family, and would news like this actually change how you think about the diagnosis?

Reddit r/upliftingnews (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://www.rnz.co.nz/news/health/1483456/alzheimer-s-disease-starting-to-be-considered-a-treatable-condition-study

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## CLOSER: THE KICKER/GOODBYES

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### ■ *Mother accused of giving away baby to stranger at bus stop*

***The Angle:*** *This is a pure 'wait, what?' headline built for the kicker - a mom accused of handing her infant to a total stranger waiting for a bus is the kind of story that makes you stop scrolling and read it twice.*

- A **mother** is accused of giving her **baby** away to a **stranger** at a **bus stop**
- Story surfaced via **r/nottheonion**, the subreddit for real headlines too weird to believe

**The Disbelief Reaction**

- Just react live to the headline - let the audience hear you try to process 'she did WHAT at a bus stop?'

Reddit r/nottheonion (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://www.kgns.tv/2026/09/20/mother-18-arrested-after-giving-away-baby-stranger-bus-stop-police-say/

Backup options:

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### ■■ *Shopify CEO says employees' 'slop grenades' are making more work for everyone else*

***The Angle:*** *AI slop has invaded the workplace, and now a Fortune 500 CEO is calling it out by name — a relatable jab at low-effort AI-generated work getting dumped on other people's plates.*

- **Shopify CEO** publicly criticized employees for producing what he called **'slop grenades'**
- The term describes low-quality, AI-generated work products that create extra cleanup work for coworkers
- Story picked up by **r/nottheonion**, framed as almost too absurd to be real corporate speak

**The Office Confessional**

- Have you ever gotten handed an obvious AI 'slop grenade' at work — and how'd you handle it?

Reddit r/nottheonion (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://fortune.com/2026/09/17/shopify-tobias-lutke-ai-slop-grenades/

## FLEX (cap check: THE GREAT DEBATE 1/4 this month; TECH TALK 3/3 this month; Advice/Relationship Cluster 4/3 this month)

(no flex-slot candidates cleared the cap/score bar today)

## BREAKOUT WATCH (below the show's usual engagement bar - included on editorial judgment, not metrics; producer's call)

### ■■ *Lawsuit says Anthropic, OpenAI, SpaceXAI and Google made illegal agreement on AI slowdown*

■ **Breakout potential** (editorial judgment, below the usual engagement bar): Naming Anthropic, OpenAI, SpaceXAI and Google in a single antitrust collusion lawsuit is a big-name, novel legal angle that rides the growing 'AI industry cartel' narrative trending in tech regulation coverage.
***The Angle:*** *A new lawsuit claims **Anthropic**, **OpenAI**, **xAI**, and **Google** secretly agreed to throttle AI development — a huge story if true, since these are the companies racing to build the tech reshaping everyday life.*

- Lawsuit names **Anthropic**, **OpenAI**, **SpaceXAI (xAI)**, and **Google** as defendants
- Core claim: the companies made an **illegal agreement** to slow down AI progress
- Details are still thin — this is breaking off a headline, more specifics expected to surface

**The Debate Starter**

- If the biggest AI companies really agreed to hit the brakes together, is that a scandal — or exactly what we should want them doing?

Reddit r/technology (Tier 1) | Score: 58/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 11 quality - 10 penalty (Depressing/negative tone)) -> STRONG

URL: https://www.cnn.com/2026/09/19/business/ai-slowdown-lawsuit-antitrust

### ■ *Explosive 'NAZA' Documentary, Attacked By Israeli Government, To Be Released In U.S. Theaters*

■ **Breakout potential** (editorial judgment, below the usual engagement bar): A documentary 'attacked by the Israeli government' getting a US theatrical release despite that pressure is a suppression narrative with built-in controversy that tends to generate outsized attention regardless of starting upvotes.
***The Angle:*** *A documentary just controversial enough to get slammed by the Israeli government is still landing in American theaters, which instantly turns it into a free-speech-versus-politics flashpoint — exactly the kind of story that gets people picking sides before they've even seen the film.*

- A documentary referred to as **'NAZA'** is reportedly being attacked by the **Israeli government**.
- Despite that pushback, the film is still set for a **U.S. theatrical release**.
- Specific details on the filmmakers, subject matter, and release date aren't confirmed yet — worth digging into before air.

**The Debate Starter**

- When a government attacks a film and it gets released anyway, does that make you more curious to see it — or more skeptical of it?

Reddit r/entertainment (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://deadline.com/2026/09/naza-u-s-theatrical-release-1237107835/

### ■ *TW:SA. Mama Stanley makes appearance at pre-game Edmonton Oilers protest over the singing of Hockey Canada accused player Alex Formenton. Her petition calling for the singing to be reversed has garnered over 69k signatures!*

■ **Breakout potential** (editorial judgment, below the usual engagement bar): An active petition plus an in-person stadium protest tied to the ongoing Hockey Canada assault case shows real-world momentum already building, which text-only stories rarely have.
***The Angle:*** *A grassroots petition just crossed 69,000 signatures and turned into a real protest outside an NHL preseason game - that's a fanbase openly clashing with front office over a Hockey Canada-linked signing, which is exactly the kind of story that splits a room.*

- About **100 people** protested outside Saturday's Oilers preseason game over the signing of **Alex Formenton**
- The petition, started by longtime fan **Mary Loewen** (aka **"Mama Stanley"**), has topped **69,000 signatures**
- Loewen, a **survivor of sexual assault** herself, said other survivors have messaged her, sharing stories they'd never told anyone before
- Her message to the crowd: **"Before anything else, I am a survivor... we are standing here peacefully today because survivors have spoken."**

**The Debate Starter**

- Should a petition and a protest be enough to make a pro team reverse a signing?

Reddit r/fauxmoi (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL:
https://www.ctvnews.ca/edmonton/article/mama-stanley-makes-appearance-at-pre-game-oilers-protest-in-wake-of-formenton-controversy/

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### ■ *Is everyone Bricking their phones without you? The anti-FOMO (and anti-doomscroll) wellness craze https://t.co/3jMCT4i8d3 https://t.co/DhhwQ*

■ **Breakout potential** (editorial judgment, below the usual engagement bar): The 'Brick' anti-smartphone device taps directly into the accelerating digital-detox/dumbphone trend that's been gaining cultural steam, giving it a specific, on-trend hook beyond generic wellness content.
***The Angle:*** *It's the opposite of doomscrolling: people are voluntarily locking their phones down to kill FOMO and screen-time guilt, and it's becoming a whole wellness trend worth unpacking on air.*

- The trend is called **"Bricking"** your phone — basically making your smartphone temporarily act like a dumbphone.
- It's being framed as an **anti-FOMO, anti-doomscroll** wellness move, not just a digital detox gimmick.
- **@NYPost** is flagging it as a growing lifestyle craze right now.

**The Confession Booth**

- Be honest — could you survive a week with your phone 'bricked,' or are you checking it before you even finish reading this?

**ON-AIR BIT BREAKDOWN**

- **Step 1: The Brick Test** - 60 seconds, cold open -> Both hosts hand their phones to the other host / producer for the rest of the segment and talk about how it feels not having it in reach.
- **Step 2: Confess Your Screen Time** - 2 minutes, mid-segment -> Hosts pull up their actual daily screen-time number live and react to each other's before opening phone lines for listeners to share theirs.
- **Step 3: Would You Actually Brick It?** - Wrap-up -> Quick gut-check poll: hosts and callers vote yes/no on whether they'd try bricking their phone for a full day.

X/Twitter @NYPost (Tier 1) | Score: 72/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 15 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://x.com/nypost/status/2101990181364547867

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## FRANCHISE BANK

WHAT THE FRIDAY: 3 banked (+15 each when found)
- "Tiny mouse brawl breaks out on London subway platform" (nypost.com, banked 2026-09-08)
- "Dramatic video shows naked man being pulled from East River by NYC cops" (nypost.com, banked 2026-09-09)
- "Lady wtf, your kid is right there!" (X/Twitter @WomenBeingAwful, banked 2026-09-16)

THROWBACK THURSDAY: 16 banked (+15 each when found)

- "Zendaya Rings in 30 with an Adorable Throwback Photo: ‘So Much to Be Grateful for’ - people.com" (People (via Google News), banked 2026-09-01)
- "Here’s Why Fifth Harmony Fans Think the Girl Group Is Making a Comeback Ahead of Anniversary" (X/Twitter @Billboard, banked 2026-09-06)
- "Rachael Leigh Cook surprises fans at ‘Josie and the Pussycats’ 25th anniversary screening" (pagesix.com, banked 2026-09-07)
- "Stevie Wonder Announces ‘Songs in the Key of Life’ 50th Anniversary Tour https://t.co/trmKJsgwqb" (X/Twitter @Variety, banked 2026-09-08)
- "Michael Goodwin: Mamdani’s toxic Ground Zero blame game just latches on to still-open 9/11 wounds to boost himself" (nypost.com, banked 2026-09-08)
- "John Oliver to Host Comic Relief Live’s 40th Anniversary Show" (www.hollywoodreporter.com, banked 2026-09-09)
- "Where I was on 9/11: 4 people in N.L. share their stories of stepping up to help" (www.cbc.ca, banked 2026-09-11)
- "Gander mayor reflects on 25th anniversary of 9/11" (CTV News (via Google News), banked 2026-09-11)
- "Globe editorial: Nostalgia is no strategy for U.S. relations" (The Globe and Mail (via Google News), banked 2026-09-11)
- "Universal Studios Japan Celebrates Halloween With First R-Rated Attraction" (gizmodo.com, banked 2026-09-13)
- "‘Practical Magic 2’ Dazzles Up a Bit Of an Audience" (gizmodo.com, banked 2026-09-14)
- "The London revival of “Sunday in the Park With George” has been canceled following the exits of stars Ariana Grande and Jonathan Bailey." (X/Twitter @Variety, banked 2026-09-14)
- "'Sunday in the Park With George' London Revival Canceled After Ariana Grande, Jonathan Bailey Exits https://t.co/cPQ2IIvYql" (X/Twitter @Variety, banked 2026-09-14)
- "‘Sunday in the Park With George’ revival scrapped after Ariana Grande, Jonathan Bailey exits" (Entertainment Weekly (via Google News), banked 2026-09-14)
- "Margot Robbie stuns in a retro bikini as she joins shirtless Bradley Cooper to shoot the Ocean's Eleven 1960s prequel on the French Riviera" (www.dailymail.co.uk, banked 2026-09-16)
- "Here’s Why Fifth Harmony Fans Think the Girl Group Is Making a Comeback Ahead of Anniversary" (X/Twitter @Billboard, banked 2026-09-20)

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## SOURCES SKIPPED THIS RUN:

- @CBCNews (fetch failed)
- @globalnews (no posts cleared the 30+ likes bar - 2 below-bar candidate(s) considered for breakout potential)
- @Gizmodo (no posts cleared the 30+ likes bar - 5 below-bar candidate(s) considered for breakout potential)
- Morning Brew (OpenCLI browser-scrape returned nothing - check Chrome/bridge)
- 1 story(ies) removed after slotting (content-safety and/or not-significant-enough for THE LIST/TRENDING TODAY; automatically backfilled where possible; see run log)

Scout Report Generated: 2026-09-21 09:39 AM